



Rewarding outing: Dhruv Jurel was nimble on his feet and acrobatic in his movements behind the stumps.

GETTYIMAGES

how strictly he manages the youngsters (*laughs*). It's fun to be around Rohit *bhai*, as you get to learn so much from him.

You have worked with two tough taskmasters: Rahul Dravid and Kumar Sangakkara. What have you learned from the two?

When I was part of the India U-19 team, Rahul sir was my coach. So, when I entered the senior team's dressing room, I felt comfortable since he was around.

I have worked with Sanga sir for three years. He never talks negatively, and even in tricky times, he backs me. As a young player, you need security, and Sanga sir has ensured that.

Initially, your father was not in favour of you pursuing the game, but now that you've made it to India's Test team, what's the reaction back home?

Now people have started recognising me, and of course, there's a bit of financial security. Since my father is an Army man, he always believes in staying grounded, and I try to follow in his footsteps. It's a simple thing: *aap ki cricket kitna chalegi*, maximum 10 years, but when you move on from the game, people will judge you as a person.

So, I try to be humble and kind and stay connected to my roots.

I know what I had to go through to come so far. There were times when people told me that I was wasting my time.

But now, if I can inspire even two or three youngsters from Agra, I will consider that a huge achievement. *Paise toh aate jaatein rahenge* (Money will come and go), and in life, all you need is some food and peace, but nothing can be more satisfying than inspiring youngsters to chase their dreams. I will continue doing that.